LESSON 7

Biblical Herb Studies

How to Study Herbs Responsibly

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Lesson: Lesson 7
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Education Center: Natural Health Ministries Education Center
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Lesson Overview

In Lesson 1, we learned that Biblical Herbalism begins with God as Creator. In Lesson 2, we learned what it means to be a Christian herbalist. In Lesson 3, we studied discernment and spiritual boundaries. In Lesson 4, we studied the Good Samaritan model of compassionate care. In Lesson 5, we studied prayer, scripture, and whole-person wellness. In Lesson 6, we studied biblical foods, herbs, oils, and spices.

In this lesson, we will learn **how to study herbs responsibly**.

A Christian herbal student must not simply collect herb names, copy internet claims, or repeat what sounds exciting. A responsible herbal student learns how to slow down, study carefully, ask better questions, check safety, and speak with wisdom.

Biblical herb study is not only about asking, “What does this herb do?”

It also asks:

Where does this plant appear in Scripture?
What was the biblical context?
What is the correct plant identity?
What part of the plant is used?
How has it been used traditionally?
What preparations are appropriate?
What safety concerns exist?
Who should avoid it?
Could it interact with medication?
How can I speak about it without making medical claims?
What spiritual lesson can I learn from this plant?

A Christian herbal student must learn to study herbs with both reverence and responsibility.

Lesson Scripture Foundations

2 Timothy 2:15 KJV

“Study to shew thyself approved unto God, a workman that needeth not to be ashamed, rightly dividing the word of truth.”

Proverbs 4:7 KJV

“Wisdom is the principal thing; therefore get wisdom: and with all thy getting get understanding.”

Hosea 4:6 KJV

“My people are destroyed for lack of knowledge…”

Proverbs 18:13 KJV

“He that answereth a matter before he heareth it, it is folly and shame unto him.”

James 1:5 KJV

“If any of you lack wisdom, let him ask of God, that giveth to all men liberally, and upbraideth not; and it shall be given him.”

1 Corinthians 10:31 KJV

“Whether therefore ye eat, or drink, or whatsoever ye do, do all to the glory of God.”

Lesson Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

1. Explain why herb study must be slow, careful, and responsible.
2. Understand the difference between biblical mention, traditional use, and modern herbal education.
3. Identify the main parts of a basic herb study.
4. Explain why botanical name, plant part, preparation, and safety matter.
5. Recognize the importance of contraindications, allergies, and medication interactions.
6. Write a safe educational summary for one herb.
7. Complete a beginner biblical herb monograph.

Opening Teaching

A Christian herbal student must learn to study before speaking.

Many people today learn about herbs from short posts, reels, social media videos, memes, and quick internet searches. These may introduce a plant, but they are not enough for responsible herbal education.

A single sentence cannot teach safety.
A short video cannot replace study.
A social media claim cannot become a protocol.
A testimony cannot become a guarantee.
A biblical mention cannot become a medical prescription.

Herbal study requires patience.

The student must learn to slow down and ask:

What do I actually know?
Where did this information come from?
Is this herb being used safely?
Is this information traditional, biblical, scientific, personal, or promotional?
Is this herb appropriate for everyone?
Could this be harmful in certain situations?
Am I using careful language?
Am I staying within my educational role?

A Christian herbalist must not be careless with knowledge. People may trust what we say. If we speak too quickly, we can mislead people. If we make claims without understanding, we can cause confusion. If we suggest herbs without safety awareness, we can create harm.

This is why study matters.

What Is a Biblical Herb Study?

A biblical herb study is a structured way to study a plant through Scripture, traditional use, safety, and Christian reflection.

It is not just a list of benefits.

A complete biblical herb study should include:

The plant name
The botanical name, when known
The plant family

The part used
Where it appears in Scripture or biblical culture
The biblical context
Traditional uses
Modern educational uses
Preparation methods
Safety concerns
Contraindications
Medication interaction concerns
Spiritual reflection
Safe educational summary

This method helps students avoid exaggeration and teaches them to think carefully.

Biblical Herbalism does not rush from “this plant is in the Bible” to “this plant cures disease.” Responsible study includes context, safety, and humility.

Biblical Mention vs. Modern Use

One of the first lessons in herb study is understanding the difference between biblical mention and modern use.

A plant may be mentioned in Scripture, but that does not automatically tell us:

How much to use
How to prepare it
Who should avoid it
Whether it is safe in pregnancy
Whether it interacts with medication
Whether it should be used internally or externally
Whether the modern plant is the same as the ancient plant
Whether an essential oil is appropriate
Whether a product on the market is safe

For example:

Frankincense was given as a gift to Jesus. That does not mean students should take frankincense essential oil internally.

Myrrh appears in Scripture. That does not mean everyone should use myrrh without caution.

Aloes are mentioned in the Bible, but the biblical aloes may not always be the same as modern aloe vera products.

Mint, dill, and rue are mentioned in the New Testament, but the lesson from Jesus was not simply about the herbs. It was also about religious leaders neglecting judgment, mercy, faith, and the love of God.

This is why context matters.

A Christian herbal student must learn to ask:

What does the Bible actually say?
What am I assuming?
What does history show?
What does safety require?
What is appropriate for modern educational use?

The Difference Between Food Herbs and Strong Medicinal Herbs

Some plants are commonly used as foods. Others are stronger medicinal herbs. Some may be both, depending on the amount and preparation.

For example:

Garlic in soup is a food.
Concentrated garlic capsules are stronger.
Cinnamon sprinkled on oatmeal is a spice.
Cinnamon essential oil is very concentrated.
Peppermint tea is gentle for many people.
Peppermint essential oil is much stronger and not safe for everyone.
Flax sprinkled on food is different from taking large therapeutic amounts.
Olive oil in food is different from using an infused oil on skin.

Preparation changes strength.

A Christian herbal student must not assume that because something is safe as food, it is automatically safe in concentrated form.

This is one of the most important safety lessons in herbal education.

The Importance of Botanical Names

Many plants share the same common name. A common name can cause confusion.

For example, the word “mint” can refer to several different plants. “Aloe” may refer to different substances depending on biblical, historical, or modern use. “Balm” can refer to different plants or resins depending on context.

A botanical name helps identify the plant more accurately.

A botanical name usually includes two parts:

Genus
Species

For example:

Calendula officinalis
Mentha piperita
Matricaria recutita
Olea europaea
Allium sativum

Students do not need to become botanists overnight, but they do need to learn that accurate identification matters.

Using the wrong plant can be dangerous.

A responsible herb study should include the botanical name whenever possible.

The Importance of Plant Part Used

Different parts of the same plant may have different actions, strengths, and safety concerns.

Plant parts may include:

Leaf
Flower
Root
Seed
Bark
Fruit
Resin
Bulb
Oil
Latex
Aerial parts

For example:

Garlic bulb is used as food and traditional herb.
Olive fruit produces olive oil.
Flax seed may be used as food.

Cinnamon bark is used as a spice.
Frankincense resin is different from frankincense essential oil.
Aloe gel is different from aloe latex.

This matters because safety can change depending on the plant part.

A student must never say, “This plant is safe,” without asking, “Which part of the plant?”

The Importance of Preparation

Preparation changes how an herb works and how strong it is.

Common preparations include:

Tea or infusion
Decoction
Tincture
Capsule
Powder
Infused oil
Salve
Poultice
Syrup
Steam
Bath
Food seasoning
Essential oil

Each preparation has different strength and safety concerns.

A tea is not the same as a tincture.
A tincture is not the same as a capsule.
A capsule is not the same as food.
A food herb is not the same as an essential oil.
An essential oil is not the same as the whole plant.

Students must be especially careful with essential oils. Essential oils are concentrated plant extracts. They require training, dilution, safety knowledge, and caution. Biblical references to frankincense, myrrh, cinnamon, or other aromatic plants should not automatically be translated into modern internal essential oil use.

Safe study asks:

What preparation is being used?
How strong is it?

Is it internal or external?
Who is it for?
How long is it used?
Are there safety concerns?
Is this within my scope?

The Importance of Safety

Safety is not optional.

Safety is part of loving your neighbor.

A Christian herbal student must learn to look for:

Allergies
Pregnancy concerns
Nursing concerns
Child safety
Elder safety
Medication interactions
Medical conditions
Surgery concerns
Dosage concerns
Preparation concerns
Quality concerns
Contamination concerns
Misidentification concerns
Individual sensitivity

Not every herb is right for every person.

A safe herb for one person may be wrong for another. A food that nourishes one person may trigger another person's allergy. A calming herb may interact with sedating medications. A stimulating herb may not be appropriate for someone with anxiety or heart concerns. A blood-moving herb may not be appropriate before surgery or with blood-thinning medications.

The Christian herbalist must not be offended by safety. Safety is stewardship.

Contraindications

A contraindication is a reason a person should avoid a particular herb, food, preparation, or practice.

Contraindications may include:

Pregnancy
Nursing
Medication use
Upcoming surgery
Bleeding disorders
High or low blood pressure
Kidney disease
Liver disease
Autoimmune conditions
Allergies
Children
Elders
Seizure history
Hormone-sensitive conditions
Severe digestive weakness
Known sensitivity to the plant family

A beginner student should never assume they know all contraindications. This is why research is necessary.

When in doubt, say:

“This is outside my current knowledge. Please consult a qualified healthcare provider.”

That is wisdom.

Medication Interactions

Herbs can interact with medications.

This is very important.

Some herbs may affect blood thinning.
Some may affect blood sugar.
Some may affect blood pressure.
Some may affect sedation.
Some may affect digestion and absorption.
Some may affect liver enzymes.
Some may affect hormones.
Some may affect immune activity.

A Christian herbalist should never tell someone to stop medication. Medication decisions belong to the client and their licensed healthcare provider.

Safe language:

“Because herbs may interact with medications, please consult your healthcare provider or pharmacist before using this herb.”

A Christian herbal student should not feel embarrassed to say this. It shows maturity.

The Importance of Individual Constitution

People are different.

Some people run hot.
Some run cold.
Some are dry.
Some are damp.
Some are tense.
Some are depleted.
Some are sensitive.
Some are robust.
Some are children.
Some are elders.
Some are pregnant.
Some are chronically ill.
Some are on medications.

A herb that fits one person may not fit another.

For example:

A warming herb may be too heating for someone already hot and inflamed.
A drying herb may be too drying for someone already dry.
A stimulating herb may be too much for someone anxious or depleted.
A sedating herb may be too strong with sedating medication.

This is why one-size-fits-all herbalism is not wise.

A Christian herbalist should treat each person as uniquely created by God.

The Importance of Source Quality

Where herbs come from matters.

Poor quality herbs may be old, moldy, contaminated, adulterated, incorrectly identified, or improperly stored.

A responsible herbal student should consider:

Is the herb correctly identified?
Is it from a trusted source?
Is it organic or responsibly grown when possible?
Is it free from mold or contamination?
Is it stored away from heat, light, and moisture?
Is it labeled clearly?
Is there a harvest or expiration date?
Is the supplier transparent?
Is the plant endangered or overharvested?

Stewardship includes caring about quality.

Cheap is not always safe. Expensive is not always better. Students must learn to evaluate sources with wisdom.

Ethical Harvesting and Stewardship

Christian herbalism should include care for creation.

God gave the earth, but He did not give permission for careless destruction.

Ethical harvesting includes:

Correct plant identification
Permission to harvest
Avoiding polluted areas
Taking only what is needed
Leaving enough for the plant to continue growing
Leaving enough for pollinators and wildlife
Avoiding endangered plants
Harvesting at the proper time
Drying and storing properly
Giving thanks to God

Ethical sourcing also matters when purchasing herbs.

A Christian herbal student should ask:

Was this herb harvested responsibly?
Was it grown or wildcrafted ethically?
Is this plant endangered?
Were workers treated fairly?

Am I using more than I need?
Does this practice honor God’s creation?

Stewardship is spiritual and practical.

Researching Herbs Responsibly

A Christian herbal student should not rely on only one source.

Responsible herb study may include:

Scripture
Herbal textbooks
Materia medica references
Herbal monographs
Safety databases
Botanical references
Traditional use references
Scientific summaries when available
Experienced teachers
Clinical herbalist writings
Reputable educational institutions
Professional guidance when needed

Students should compare sources.

Ask:

Do several sources agree?
Are there safety warnings?
Is the source selling something?
Is the language exaggerated?
Does the source make cure claims?
Does the source mention contraindications?
Is the source spiritualized in a way that conflicts with Scripture?
Is the source current and responsible?

Not all herbal information is equal.

A Christian herbalist should be teachable, careful, and humble.

The Biblical Herb Study Template

Use this template when studying a biblical herb, food, oil, spice, or plant.

1. Common Name

What is the common name of the herb or plant?

2. Botanical Name

What is the botanical name, if known?

3. Plant Family

What plant family does it belong to?

4. Plant Part Used

What part is used?

Leaf
Flower
Root
Seed
Bark
Fruit
Resin
Bulb
Oil
Latex
Aerial parts

5. Biblical Reference or Connection

Where is it mentioned in Scripture or biblical culture?

6. Biblical Context

How is it being used in the passage?

Food
Fragrance
Gift
Anointing
Symbol
Medicine
Burial

Trade
Household use
Worship context

7. Traditional Uses

How has this plant been used traditionally?

8. Modern Educational Uses

How is it commonly discussed in modern herbal education?

9. Preparation Methods

How is it prepared?

Tea
Food
Tincture
Capsule
Oil
Salve
Poultice
Resin
Spice
Essential oil

10. Safety Notes

What safety issues should be considered?

11. Contraindications

Who should avoid it?

12. Medication Interaction Concerns

Could it interact with medications or medical conditions?

13. Spiritual Reflection

What does this plant teach about God’s provision, wisdom, stewardship, patience, nourishment, or compassion?

14. Safe Educational Summary

Write a short paragraph using careful language without diagnosing, prescribing, treating, curing, or making medical claims.

Example Herb Study: Garlic

Common Name: Garlic

Botanical Name: Allium sativum

Plant Family: Amaryllidaceae

Plant Part Used: Bulb

Biblical Connection: Garlic is connected to the Israelites' memory of foods eaten in Egypt.

Biblical Context: It appears as a food remembered by the people, not as a prescription.

Traditional Uses: Garlic has been used as a food, seasoning, and traditional wellness herb in many cultures.

Modern Educational Uses: Garlic is commonly discussed as a kitchen herb that may support general wellness when used appropriately.

Preparation Methods: Food, raw, cooked, infused in oil, capsules, extracts, or powders.

Safety Notes: Garlic may irritate digestion, worsen reflux, thin the blood, increase bleeding risk, interact with blood-thinning medications, and may not be appropriate before surgery or for sensitive individuals.

Contraindications: Use caution with bleeding disorders, blood-thinning medications, upcoming surgery, digestive ulcers, reflux, pregnancy in medicinal amounts, and known allergy.

Medication Interaction Concerns: Blood thinners, antiplatelet drugs, surgery-related medications, and some other medications may require caution.

Spiritual Reflection: Garlic reminds us that foods can be simple, strong, and useful, but they must still be used with wisdom. A food remembered in Scripture should not become a careless claim.

Safe Educational Summary: Garlic is a biblical and traditional food herb. It may be used in cooking and studied for its traditional wellness uses, but concentrated garlic preparations require caution, especially for individuals taking medication, preparing for surgery, or experiencing digestive sensitivity. This information is educational and not a prescription or treatment.

Example Herb Study: Cinnamon

Common Name: Cinnamon

Botanical Name: Cinnamomum species

Plant Family: Lauraceae

Plant Part Used: Bark

Biblical Connection: Cinnamon is mentioned among precious spices.

Biblical Context: It appears as a valuable aromatic spice, not as a medical prescription.

Traditional Uses: Cinnamon has been used as a warming spice in food, beverages, and traditional wellness preparations.

Modern Educational Uses: Cinnamon is commonly used in cooking and is often studied for its aromatic and warming qualities.

Preparation Methods: Food spice, tea, powder, capsule, extract, or essential oil.

Safety Notes: Cinnamon essential oil is highly concentrated and can irritate skin. Cassia cinnamon contains coumarin, which may be a concern in high amounts. Cinnamon may affect blood sugar and may not be appropriate in concentrated amounts for everyone.

Contraindications: Use caution with pregnancy in medicinal amounts, liver concerns, blood sugar medications, sensitive skin, and essential oil use.

Medication Interaction Concerns: Diabetes medications, blood-thinning medications, and liver-sensitive medications may require caution.

Spiritual Reflection: Cinnamon reminds us that fragrance and flavor are part of God’s creation. Precious spices in Scripture should be studied with reverence and safety.

Safe Educational Summary: Cinnamon is a biblical spice valued for fragrance and flavor. It may be used in food amounts by many people, but concentrated cinnamon products and essential oils require safety awareness. This information is educational only.

Example Herb Study: Olive Oil

Common Name: Olive Oil

Botanical Name: Olea europaea

Plant Family: Oleaceae

Plant Part Used: Fruit oil

Biblical Connection: Olive oil appears throughout Scripture in food, lamps, anointing, and practical care.

Biblical Context: Olive oil was part of daily life and sacred symbolism. It was also mentioned in the Good Samaritan story.

Traditional Uses: Food oil, lamp oil, skin care, anointing oil, and carrier oil.

Modern Educational Uses: Olive oil is used as a nourishing food oil and as a carrier oil in topical herbal preparations.

Preparation Methods: Food, infused oil, salve, topical oil, anointing oil.

Safety Notes: Oils can become rancid. Topical oils may not be appropriate on infected, deep, or serious wounds. Some people may have sensitivities.

Contraindications: Avoid topical use on serious wounds without medical care. Use caution with allergies, skin sensitivity, and poor-quality oil.

Medication Interaction Concerns: Food amounts are generally common, but individual dietary needs should be considered.

Spiritual Reflection: Olive oil reminds us of provision, light, consecration, and practical care. It should point us back to God, not become an object of superstition.

Safe Educational Summary: Olive oil is a significant biblical oil used in food, lamps, anointing, and practical care. It may be studied as part of biblical plant education and general wellness stewardship, but it should not be treated as magical or as a replacement for medical care.

Common Mistakes in Herb Study

Students should avoid these common mistakes:

Mistake 1: Copying Claims Without Checking Safety

Do not repeat claims just because they sound exciting.

Mistake 2: Assuming Natural Means Safe

Natural substances can still cause harm when misused.

Mistake 3: Ignoring Medications

Herbs can interact with medications.

Mistake 4: Confusing Food Amounts With Medicinal Amounts

A sprinkle of spice is not the same as a concentrated capsule.

Mistake 5: Treating Biblical Mention as a Prescription

Scripture must be studied in context.

Mistake 6: Using Essential Oils Carelessly

Essential oils are concentrated and require training.

Mistake 7: Making Disease Claims

Do not claim an herb cures, treats, or prevents disease.

Mistake 8: Ignoring the Individual

Each person has unique needs, allergies, medications, and constitution.

Mistake 9: Forgetting Prayer and Discernment

Christian herbal study should stay rooted in God's wisdom.

Mistake 10: Becoming Prideful

Knowledge should produce humility, not superiority.

Safe Educational Language for Herb Studies

A Christian herbal student should practice safe wording.

Instead of saying:

"This herb cures infection."

Say:

"This herb has been traditionally used to support general wellness, but it is not a replacement for medical care."

Instead of saying:

“Everyone should take this.”

Say:

“This herb may not be appropriate for everyone. Safety, allergies, medications, and individual needs must be considered.”

Instead of saying:

“This biblical herb will heal you.”

Say:

“This plant is connected to Scripture or biblical culture, and we study it with gratitude, context, and safety.”

Instead of saying:

“This is God’s medicine, so it cannot hurt you.”

Say:

“God created plants, and we must use wisdom, because natural products can still be harmful if misused.”

Instead of saying:

“You can stop your medicine.”

Say:

“Medication decisions should be made with your licensed healthcare provider.”

Safe language honors God and protects people.

Creating an Herb Journal

Every Christian herbal student should begin an herb journal.

An herb journal may include:

Herb name
Botanical name
Sketch or photo

Plant family
Plant part used
Scripture reference
Traditional uses
Taste
Smell
Energetics
Preparation method
Safety notes
Personal observations
Prayer reflections
Research sources
Questions for further study

The herb journal helps students grow slowly and carefully.

A student might begin with simple herbs and foods such as:

Olive oil
Honey
Garlic
Cinnamon
Mint
Dill
Almond
Flax
Fig
Pomegranate
Frankincense
Myrrh
Balm

The goal is not to know everything at once. The goal is to build a habit of careful study.

The Spiritual Lesson of Slow Study

In herbalism, slow study is a blessing.

Plants grow in seasons.
Roots take time.
Seeds need soil.
Fruit does not appear overnight.
Harvest requires patience.
Preparation requires care.

The same is true for the student.

Do not rush your learning.
Do not rush your calling.
Do not rush into teaching before you understand.
Do not rush into formulas before you know safety.
Do not rush into ministry without prayer.
Do not rush into confidence without humility.

God often grows wisdom slowly.

A Christian herbalist must be willing to be a student before becoming a teacher.

Teacher’s Teaching Notes

When teaching this lesson, emphasize that herb study is a discipline. Students should not feel overwhelmed by the amount of information. They are learning a method.

Encourage students to start with one herb at a time. A good herb study does not have to be perfect, but it should be thoughtful.

Remind students that Christian herbalism is not only about gathering information. It is about becoming a wise steward of knowledge.

Teach students to ask:

What does Scripture say?
What does tradition say?
What does safety say?
What does wisdom say?
What is within my scope?
How can I communicate this responsibly?

This lesson prepares students for future materia medica work, biblical plant studies, herbal preparation classes, and client education.

Student Reflection

Answer the following questions in your notebook or student workbook.

1. Why is careful herb study important?
2. What is the danger of copying herbal claims without researching them?
3. Why does botanical name matter?

4. Why does plant part matter?
5. How can preparation change the strength and safety of an herb?
6. What are contraindications?
7. Why should medication interactions be considered?
8. What is the difference between a biblical mention and a modern wellness use?
9. Why should Christian herbal students avoid disease claims?
10. How can slow study honor God?

Biblical Herb Study Practice

Choose **one** biblical herb, food, oil, spice, or plant and complete the full herb study below.

Common Name:

Botanical Name:

Plant Family:

Plant Part Used:

Biblical Reference or Connection:

Biblical Context:

Traditional Uses:

Modern Educational Uses:

Preparation Methods:

Safety Notes:

Contraindications:

Medication Interaction Concerns:

Spiritual Reflection:

Safe Educational Summary:

Vocabulary Words

Herb Study: A structured review of a plant's identity, biblical connection, traditional use, preparation, safety, and spiritual reflection.

Botanical Name: The scientific Latin name used to identify a plant more accurately.

Plant Family: A group of related plants that may share characteristics or potential allergy concerns.

Plant Part Used: The specific part of the plant used, such as leaf, flower, root, seed, bark, resin, bulb, fruit, or oil.

Preparation: The way an herb is made or used, such as tea, tincture, capsule, oil, salve, food, or essential oil.

Contraindication: A reason a person should avoid a particular herb, food, or preparation.

Medication Interaction: A possible effect an herb may have on a medication or medical treatment.

Monograph: A detailed written study of one herb or plant.

Energetics: The traditional qualities of an herb, such as warming, cooling, drying, moistening, relaxing, or stimulating.

Safe Educational Summary: A careful explanation of an herb that avoids diagnosing, prescribing, treating, curing, or making exaggerated claims.

Lesson 7 Summary

Biblical herb study requires wisdom, patience, prayer, and safety. A Christian herbal student should not copy claims or rush into formulas. Instead, the student should learn how to study one plant at a time.

A responsible herb study includes the common name, botanical name, plant family, plant part used, biblical reference, traditional use, preparation, safety notes, contraindications, medication interactions, spiritual reflection, and safe educational language.

Students must remember that biblical mention does not automatically create a modern medical claim. Natural does not always mean safe. Food amounts are different from concentrated preparations. Essential oils are different from whole herbs. Each person has unique needs.

Remember:

Study before speaking.
Check the plant identity.

Learn the plant part.
Understand the preparation.
Respect safety.
Consider medications.
Avoid disease claims.
Use educational language.
Pray for wisdom.
Stay humble.
Keep Christ at the center.

Closing Prayer

Father God,

Thank You for the plants, foods, herbs, oils, spices, and trees You have placed upon the earth. Thank You for the opportunity to study Your creation with reverence and wisdom.

Teach me to be patient in my learning. Keep me from careless claims, pride, confusion, and unsafe advice. Help me to study carefully, speak truthfully, and serve responsibly.

Give me wisdom to understand safety, humility to admit what I do not know, and discernment to separate truth from error. Let every herb study point me back to You as Creator, Provider, and ultimate Healer.

In Jesus' name,
Amen.

Instructor Closing

Students, Lesson 7 teaches us that herb study is a responsibility.

You do not have to know every herb today. You do not have to master every preparation today. But you do need to learn how to study carefully.

A Christian herbalist must not be careless with God's creation or with people's trust.

Slow down.
Pray.
Research.
Check safety.
Use good sources.
Stay within your scope.
Ask questions.
Keep learning.
Remain humble.

Herbal knowledge is a gift, but it must be stewarded well.

This is how we study herbs responsibly as Christian herbalists.